



THE
LUTHERAN CHURCH
MISSOURI SYNOD

**Living Savior Lutheran Church and
Preschool**

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March 14, 2020

Dear Friends,

The Board of Servant Leaders (BOSL) hopes that this letter finds you and your family well and safe in the midst of the nation's health emergency. Less than ten days ago we wrote to inform you of what Living Savior Lutheran Church is doing to reduce the risk of spread of the Coronavirus while striving to continue to meet the spiritual needs of our church community. After prayerful consideration your BOSL has voted to keep LSLC open this Sunday (March 15th) and hold services at our regular times under modified conditions in order to ensure safety to the fullest extent possible. Please be assured that Pastor Andy and Vicar Brad agree that for the time being, we should leave our doors open to worship with these modifications.

In order to ensure everyone's personal safety, the following conditions are in place for our 8:30 and 11:00 am services tomorrow:

- There will be no communion at either service
- The Offertory plate will be placed in the back of the church and members can contribute before or after church services
- Ushers will wear gloves while handling and counting money from the plate
- No attendance books will be handed out
- No individual peace will be shared
- Please do not shake hands when greeting one another
- Congregants should choose seating that takes advantage of the full space (do not shy away from sitting up front!)
- We plan to stream the service live at both services (Dave Huxsoll, our Communication Ministry lead is working the technical piece on this, look for guidance on our webpage tomorrow).

- There will no Sunday School (all levels - children and adults)
- We will not have a coffee hour (no coffee, cups, or food of any kind)
- We will leave one narthex door open and the doors to the sanctuary open before, during, and after service in order to minimize touching of any common surface
- Susanna will continue to clean common areas frequently before, during, and after each service

We care about each one of you and encourage you to make your attendance choice based on what suits your personal circumstances. Please know that our fellowship and worship include you whether you are at church service or you are at home. We ask that you watch the live streaming at home and refrain from attending church if you are not feeling well (temperature 100.4 degrees or higher, chills, sore throat) have a compromised immune system, are elderly with a chronic health condition, or are just not comfortable being around others at this time.

We will continue to monitor the situation and decide on a week by week basis whether to hold worship services until this pandemic passes. For your reference, below is a message from the Southeastern District that the BOSL took under advisement in making this decision. The ultimate goal is to maximize the health and well-being of all congregants.

We ask that you continue to raise up in prayers those who are affected by the disease, the health care workers who are providing assistance to them and government leaders who are responding to this situation.

Praise the Lord, my soul, and forget not all his benefits— who forgives all your sins and heals all your diseases, who redeems your life from the pit and crowns you with love and compassion. Psalm 103:2-4

Blessings,

Andy Lissy, Pastor

Chuck Froemke, President

Please see attached letter.

LCMS Southeastern District Coronavirus Update

Dear Partners in Ministry,

Greetings on this Friday in Lent when we are reminded that even on the darkest of Fridays, Easter is coming!

The news about the coronavirus is coming fast and changing by the minute. Today we wake up to find many school systems are closed, colleges are moving to on-line only through end of year, offices are initiating off-site work protocols.

And the church? How should we respond in this time. Always with care and compassion toward those in our church families and communities. Currently the discussion is about suspending public worship and closing our schools? This is never an easy decision, and so, President John Denninger and I are recommending that you consider the well-being of your congregation and the guidance of your local and state government. The purpose for the closures is to show care for all the people of our community and to help stop the spread of the virus. It is an act of care and compassion to take this preventative measure. No one is choosing to close businesses and schools because they need a break or missed those snow days. These closures have a tremendous impact on so many people. So, continue the prayers and take time to check in with your local schools, businesses, and neighboring congregations as you make a decision to hold public services and meetings.

Consider how you may connect with your members in new ways. Perhaps you can identify members in the various neighborhoods of your church community who would be willing to hold a home Bible study or devotional service.

If you are live streaming, using Facebook, or podcasts – make certain your members know how to connect. In the Office, we are checking our list and will update it – placing it on the homepage so that individuals may find a nearby congregation who is on-line. Please check our [current listing](#) and contact [Ryan Radke](#) to update.

Make certain that your emails and phone chains are working and being used frequently. Communications from you provide much more than information – your words bring encouragement and hope. In these moments when the news is changing by the minute – your voice is comforting.

Take this time to do a deep cleaning of the church and school. Be certain that public areas are getting cleaned frequently. Remind members and students that it is okay to stay home if they are not feeling well. And remember that washing hands will do much to slow the spread of the virus.

There is so much to consider. Please know that you are in our prayers as you shepherd in these days. God be with you and keep you safe.

In His service,
John Denninger, President Southeastern District
Sally J Hiller, Executive Director for Congregational Outreach
Southeastern District LCMS| 800-637-5723